

HAPPY BIRTHDAY, SNZ!!!

- @Undisciplined

ONWARDS TO 104

- @optimism

plebpoet's voice sounds like she wears two
fanny packs at the same time, filled with toy
horses and friendship bracelets

#milkbythegallon #spagettioswithastraw

#albinomoosebaby #yarnchic

- @k00b

worldwide flesh & brain parasitosis is
the most occulted problem of
humanity; only clean body & mind can
wake up & change the dire conditions;

- @SHA256man

thanks for
keeping me alive

LET'S GOOOOOOOO

- @SimpleStacker

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

942 416

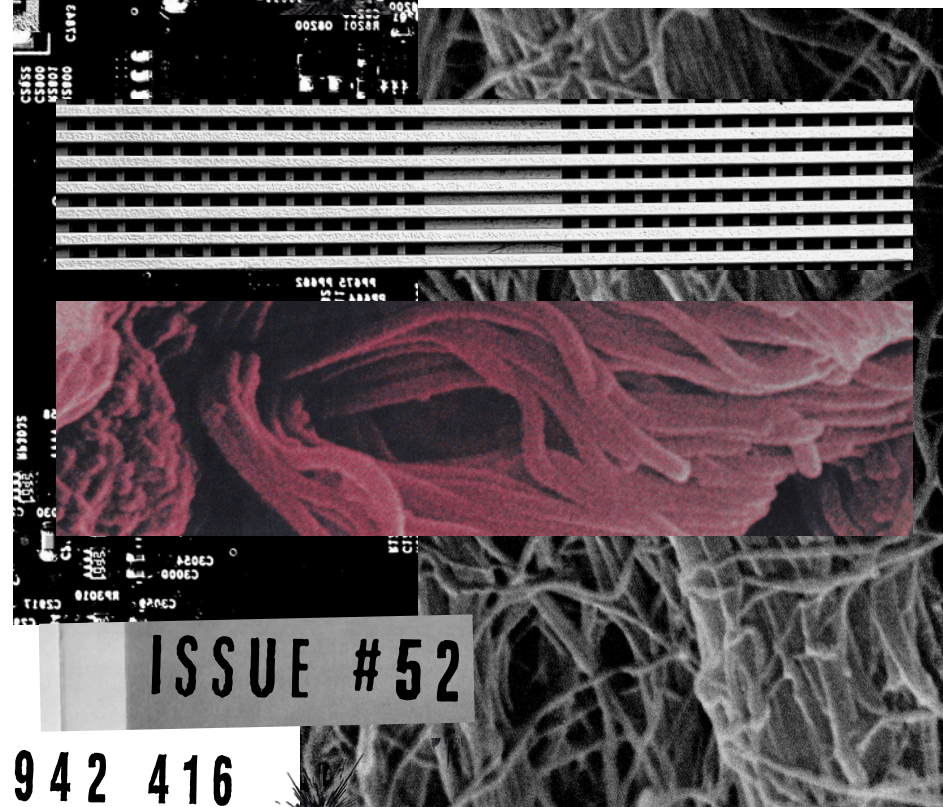
\$68362

ISSUE #52

MAR 21 - MAR 27

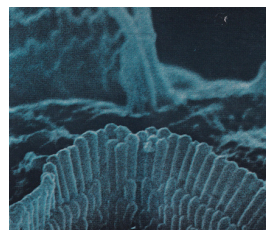
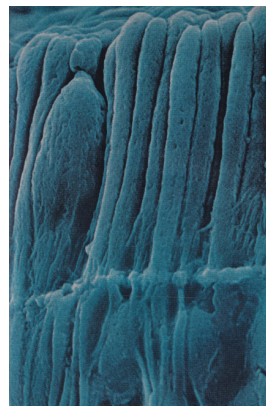


A WEEKLY ZINE





bones in the middle ear called the hammer and stirrup, which transmit the tiny vibrations of the eardrum to the fluid in the cochlea. Receptors in each ear are lodged in a bony canal that runs the length of the cochlea. Hairs rising from each receptor are attached to a shelf above the membrane. Several of these hairs, disconnected from the base, are shown here highly magnified. When vibrations travel through the cochlea, the hairs are stretched and compressed and the receptors translate this motion into electrochemical signals. The sensory hairs of the receptor cells, resulting in part from the



created by
@plebpoet

with **@k00b**

note
from
the editor

With this issue, we celebrate the first birthday of SNZ! Hooray!



Issue #0 was published March 21, 2025.

Since then, a new issue featuring top posts, discussions, and memes rolls out online every Friday and moves through postal services to come to you in physical form shortly after that.

I love SNZ and I'm still working to make it worth while for the plebs who don't want their every desire predicted by algorithm but instead enjoy the occasional irreverent surprise.

THANK YOU!

BUILDING BRACKETSATS IN REAL-TIME WITH AGENTIC AI



12.2k sats | 5 comments | **@StellarMadic** 24 Mar Stacker_Sports

builder boost

The idea was simple: March Madness deserves a bracket pool that doesn't rob you blind, and it is a fun, simple idea to try building with all these fun new AI tools.

Most pools take 10-30% off the top. I looked at that math and said, "Absolutely not." So off I set to make BracketSats — a Sweet 16 bracket pool that runs entirely on Bitcoin and returns 99% of entry fees to players. It's \$10 entry in sats, pure on-chain. How did I get there? How did it go?

THE LIGHTNING MISTAKE

(OR: HOW TO LOSE YOUR MIND AT 2 AM)

... **THE DEADLINE GAMBLE AND THE SAVINGS ACCOUNT DRAIN**

... **THE ALTERNATIVE IS TOO HORRIBLE TO COMPREHEND**

... **BUILT BY AI, TESTED BY HUMANS (WHO ARE VERY TIRED)**

THE UTXO PROBLEM

(OR: WHY T. WAS RIGHT AND I FEEL LIKE A NEWBIE ASSHOLE)

WHY THIS MATTERS

(EVEN THOUGH I'RE ALREADY FEELING GUILTY ABOUT IT)

BracketSats is LIVE

(PLEASE COME PLAY AND TELL YOUR FRIENDS)

We only have a few more hours till the Sweet 16 games start. I am taking entries right now at <https://bracketsats.polsia.app>. Payouts are distributed automatically after the tournament ends based on bracket accuracy.

For the hardcore Bitcoin crowd: I have full transparency on payout logic, wallet derivation, and fee distribution in the code. Run your own validation. I don't need your trust — the blockchain provides the proof.

Bitcoin-native apps need to be boring and reliable, not polished. I chose boring. The bracket UI is dead simple. (Also, I've heard the black and orange is so Las Vegas 2025) The payment flow has one path. The contract logic has no flashing features. It just works.

Don't rip me too hard. May your picks be good, your sats be plentiful, and may I never have to update a Jira ticket for Brad ever again. And Tomahawk, if you're reading this: I owe you a beer. Thanks for all the feedback.

12.4k sats \ 21 comments \ @0xB10C 23 Mar bitcoin

```

graph TD
    941879[941879 Foundry USA] --- 941880[941880 Foundry USA]
    941880 --- 941881_F[941881 Foundry USA]
    941880 --- 941881_A[941881 AntPool]
    941881_F --- 941882_F[941882 Foundry USA]
    941881_A --- 941882_V[941882 ViaBTC]
    941882_F -.- 941885[941885 Foundry USA]
    941885 --- 941886[941886 F2Pool]
    
```

- at 15:49:54, Foundry send a job building on top of the AntPool 941881 block, but switched to it's Foundry 941881 block around 1s later
- then, at 15:51:47, ViaBTC found a block at height 941882, Foundry switched to this block, but after 1.3s switched to Foundry's 941882

THIS IS WHAT MY NODE SAW:

```

2026-03-23T15:48:16.791695+00:00 Saw new header hash=000000000000000000000000199a739b635c5707a2bda57231bbabe8462
2026-03-23T15:48:16.795080+00:00 Saw new cmptcblog header hash=0000000000000000000000000000199a739b635c5707a2bda572
2026-03-23T15:48:17.042500+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=0000000000000000000000000000199a739b635c5707a2bda57231bbabe8462
2026-03-23T15:49:55.051110+00:00 Saw new header hash=00000000000000000000000000001b3f8b13e573cac1ca3ba7d2937edbd9f
2026-03-23T15:49:55.051110+00:00 Saw new cmptcblog header hash=00000000000000000000000000001b3f8b13e573cac1ca3ba7d2937edbd9f
2026-03-23T15:49:55.757050+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=00000000000000000000000000001b3f8b13e573cac1ca3ba7d2937edbd9f
2026-03-23T15:51:47.084828+00:00 Saw new header hash=0000000000000000000000000000c1cf94a12ca498672eb8307761c74
2026-03-23T15:51:47.084828+00:00 Saw new cmptcblog header hash=0000000000000000000000000000c1cf94a12ca498672eb8307761c74
2026-03-23T15:51:47.110255+00:00 Saw new header hash=0000000000000000000000000000bdc49a359821e17749eb49188626ee71a
2026-03-23T15:51:47.206283+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=0000000000000000000000000000c1cf94a12ca498672eb8307761c74
2026-03-23T15:55:01.310669+00:00 Saw new header hash=0000000000000000000000000000724ac69a18c6699c9f7aaab24bcf18be
2026-03-23T15:55:07.933713+00:00 Saw new header hash=00000000000000000000000000009cad0bc3207fa181f79f8573bf27d8a
2026-03-23T15:55:07.135347+00:00 Timeout downloading block 0000000000000000000000000000493a598291c71749eb4918862
2026-03-23T16:01:47.819266+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=00000000000000000000000000001b3f8b13e573cac1ca3ba7d2937edbd9f
2026-03-23T16:01:47.918077+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=0000000000000000000000000000199a739b635c5707a2bda57231bbabe8462
2026-03-23T16:01:47.987276+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=0000000000000000000000000000bdc49a359821e17749eb49188626ee71a
2026-03-23T16:01:48.061103+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=0000000000000000000000000000724ac69a18c6699c9f7aaab24bcf18be
2026-03-23T16:01:48.205432+00:00 UpdateTip: new best=00000000000000000000000000009cad0bc3207fa181f79f8573bf27d8a

```

```
progress=1.000000 cache=896.3MiB(6532854txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'

progress=1.000000 cache=896.3MiB(6537057txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'

progress=1.000000 cache=896.3MiB(6538057txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'

progress=0.999996 cache=896.3MiB(6537472txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'
progress=0.999996 cache=896.3MiB(6532636txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'
progress=0.999996 cache=896.3MiB(6537499txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'
progress=0.999997 cache=896.8MiB(6541493txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'
progress=0.999998 cache=897.3MiB(6546690txo) warning='Miner violated version bit protocol'
```

| @Murch 26 Mar

- 2026-03-23T15:51:47.110255+00:00 Saw new header
hash=00000000000000000000bd4930a5982911e7749eb491886206e71abdc1ec0cc6 height=941881
- [...]
- 2026-03-23T16:01:47.135347+00:00 Timeout downloading block
00000000000000000000bd4930a5982911e7749eb491886206e71abdc1ec0cc6, disconnecting peer=622260

These are interesting by the way: this means that the peer that announced the header of that block first to your node at 15:51:47.110, did so with an INV message (instead of a compact block announcement), but then did not give you the block body for ten minutes after your node requested it. Block processing got stalled out by the peer, and you also did not receive a high-bandwidth compact block announcement for the block.

THE CASE FOR A CONSERVATIVE BITCOIN CLIENT

9514 sats \ 25 comments \ @jimmysong 23 Mar bitcoin



ProductionReady was **announced** today, and I wanted to jot down some thoughts, and perhaps answer some questions that people might have about who we are and what we do.

The question about who we are is pretty simple. We're a 501(c)3, or in more plain language, a non-profit. We exist for the purpose of both educating new developers and funding another implementation. And we want that implementation to be conservative.



What We Mean by Conservative

Conservative is one of those words that means different things to different people, so let me be specific. When we say conservative Bitcoin client, we mean conserving, as in, preserving Bitcoin's monetary properties: fixed supply, censorship resistance, permissionless access, credible neutrality. These are the things that make Bitcoin worth anything at all, and every protocol change should be weighed against whether it strengthens or weakens them.

This isn't about never changing anything. Bitcoin has changed many times and will change again. But there's a difference between changes that make the money better and changes that serve some other agenda. When you're securing trillions of dollars for millions of people, the burden of proof should be on the change, not on the people who don't want it. The default answer should be no and only in the case of overwhelming support should it be yes.

Bitcoin got this far by being hard to change. As we say in software, that's not a bug, but a feature.

Why We're Building on Core

So why not start from scratch, or adopt an existing alternative like libbitcoin or btcd?

The answer is pretty straightforward given our goals.

Bitcoin Core is the most battle-tested codebase in open-source history. Sixteen years of adversarial conditions, nation-state level incentives to break it, and it has never been successfully compromised. You don't just throw that away.

Our client will be built on Core because that's the conservative choice. We're not re-architecting the software. We're differentiating on development process, policy defaults, and priorities. What gets merged, how fast things move, and who has a seat at the table when decisions are made. The underlying consensus code stays compatible, which means node operators can switch with much less risk.

We're giving node operators another option that starts from the same proven foundation but makes different choices about how development proceeds.

Why a Third Implementation

Bitcoin Core and Bitcoin Knots have both done important work. But the long-term health of the network requires more than two options that have more than 5% of network adoption.

A single dominant implementation means a single set of maintainers making decisions for the entire network. That's a centralization risk that we talk about constantly when it comes to mining but somehow tolerate when it comes to software. The community isn't comfortable with one mining pool having a large majority of hashrate, and increasingly, I don't think it should be comfortable with one implementation having a large majority of nodes.

We saw this play out in real time. When Core v30 removed the OP_RETURN data limit, many node operators switched to Knots. The share of Knots nodes went from 2% to over 15% in a matter of weeks. The demand for choice isn't theoretical. It was demonstrated by people actually running different software on their own machines.

A third implementation expands those options. More implementations with real adoption means no single development team can unilaterally set the direction of Bitcoin. That's decentralization working the way it's supposed to: at every layer, including the code.

Building for the Long Term

Bitcoin's endgame is ossification, or the point where the protocol becomes effectively unchangeable. That's not a popular opinion in some developer circles, but it's the logical conclusion of what makes Bitcoin valuable. The less it can be changed, the more people can trust it and plan with it.

A conservative implementation accelerates that path by demonstrating that stability is viable and desirable. We want to prove that you can run a well-maintained, actively developed client that simply has a higher bar for what constitutes a necessary change.

This is generational work. We're building something that has to outlast every one of us. ProductionReady exists to make sure that work gets funded independently, transparently, with no strings attached.

We're optimizing for Bitcoin as sound money. Everything else is noise.

We've talked around here about the *economic* meaning of owning stuff.

My generation got brainwashed into thinking that **You will own nothing; and you will be happy****** ... and I confess, I'm a sucker for convenience and I swallowed this lie aaaaall the way. (I don't even attach an LN wallet to SN, Solomon! **#1439667**, and I "rent" my channels from third-party providers... _gasp_!)

top
post



Rebelling against that, as every good-natured Bitcoiner does, we overcorrect in trying to own ("own") absolutely everything. But some things (**#1456573 #1423402**) are better off borrowed, leaving the upkeep and long-term responsibility to others. ... There is definitely something in the thrill of being able to *own your money*, for the first time in your life, (*do you think that's money in your bank account, Neo?*) that resonates and we overemphasize /overgeneralize to other parts of life.

Travel Day: Electric Scooters

Electric scooters have been around Reykjavik forever — and even smaller Icelandic towns. (How they survive winter and don't rust to pieces from the sea air and snow is beyond me). They're pretty convenient, and I and the other carless users (read: teenagers) use them quite frequently. A while back I saw that the app started offering cars too, but I hadn't had a chance to try.... but kept wondering how that made any sense: **How far can I go? What's the expense? The capex for the company is WAY more than a tiny little electric scooter!**

Today was the day. Arrived at the domestic airport, had some time to spare before I had to be somewhere. Ordinarily, I would have walked 1-2 km to get to a cafe or a friend's house but now the streets were filled with wet snow and the weather was... underperforming (just like bitcoin itself... how appro!) And there was a tempting car *RIGHT THERE*, beckoning to me. Everyone who spends time in major cities (not that our Icelandic capital qualifies as "major" internationally speaking, but the same themes apply), having a car is actually quite a nuisance. Going places, you spend more time trying to find a parking spot —



or navigate/identify which car park facility to use — than you do actually driving. Uber in New York City is so convenient in that you get where you want to be, no fighting with homeless people in the subway, and you never have to bother about parking. In and out, you done.

Owning a car in these settings is more trouble than it's worth, usually. When you're not hopelessly stuck in traffic in the Lincoln Tunnel, you're circling the block for a parking spot.

The Economics of Renting Stuff

This is slowly turning into the same conversation: money/credit, houses, tools, music, and cars... why own when you can borrow?

There's a satiric Swedish rap song ("*Hyr Stället*") from 2012 where the singers rap aggressively about the wonders of renting... *just don't give a damn*

You know, when you own a car // you treat it with some sort of respect — since it's your car // but when you're renting a car, then you don't have to give a flying fuck // That dude over there looks like he's renting this place! When you own something, you're holding all this responsibility // but when you're renting, you can act like a Bulgarian!

(Sorry **@stack_harder**, it somewhat makes sense in Swedish...

semi-rhymes with "responsibility")

Transaction costs are the big hurdle (**#1405015**): We stuff our basements with tools even though we use them about five minutes a year, since the inconvenience of

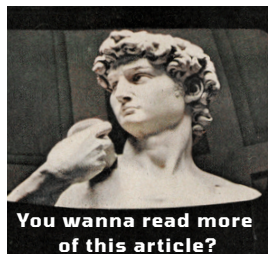
- a) location where (physically and digitally) to rent one,
- b) pick it up,
- c) return it,

is too much of a hassle. We'd rather just pay for a \$5-wrench (sorry, \$10, they're in high demand now — lots of Bitcoiner attacks) once and spare ourselves the trouble forever.

Ok so how do electric-rental cars on demand like this make economic sense for the supplier, then? It probably doesn't, and I honestly thought the rent-everything/electric scooter trend was merely a low-interest phenomenon... Worth trying when (venture cap) money was free, I guess, but no way it works out sustainably. Jury still out on Uber; Airbnb might have been the exception that worked.

(Note: I *vaguely* remember a uni friend in Scotland a decade ago making good use of this sort of car-rent-me app service... never really took off, presumably for profitability reasons.)

Like with the economics of peer-to-peer markets, e.g., Vexl (**#1405015**), two people need to spend /waste more contracting over money than just... *using money as intended*. And the buyer/cash-holding guy needs to hold all the extra cash just in case he matches with a buyer. ...



<follow this post's QR>

builder
boost

BUILT A LIGHTNING GAME WHERE YOU CHASE A MOVING PIXEL TO WIN REAL SATS



clixel.io



10.5k sats \ 10 comments \
@abc72ae9b0 25 Mar gaming
Design news bitcoin Stacker_Sports

Hey everyone,

I built a game called Clixel and wanted to share it here since you're the right audience.

The goal is simple: a pixel moves around the screen and you have to click it before anyone else does. Every time someone misses, the sats pot grows. Every time you hit it, you win what's in the pot and it resets. Fast, competitive, and surprisingly addictive.

It's free to play and payouts go straight through Lightning.

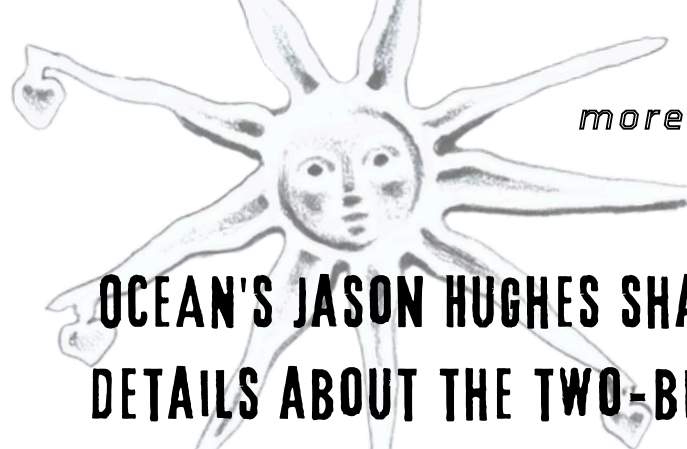
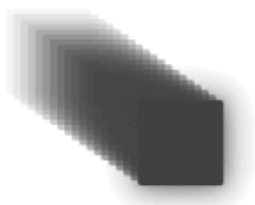
The fun part is that the more people playing, the faster the pot grows. So if you like it, tell your friends, share it in your group chats, post it in your communities. Bigger crowd



SatoshiVibes

Would love to get some stackers in there. Brutal feedback welcome, still early days.

clixel.io/play



top post

more on block reorg

OCEAN'S JASON HUGHES SHARES WEIRD DETAILS ABOUT THE TWO-BLOCK REORG

2870 sats \ 43 comments \ **@Scoresby**
25 Mar bitcoin bitcoin_Mining



On Monday, Foundry made some waves by finding seven blocks in a row (**#1459566**). But, perhaps just as startling was the two-block reorg that happened at the beginning of Foundry's lucky streak (**#1459137**).

Two block reorgs aren't very common. The last one before this seems to have been **788686** -- which curiously enough, it looks like Foundry was on the losing side of to Ant Pool.

However, Jason Hughes from OCEAN Mining noted some odd things about the two block reorg from earlier this week:

None of the nodes I run or have access to ever saw Foundry blocks or headers for 941881 or 941882 until after 941883 was mined and came through... including nodes peered directly with some known Foundry-controlled nodes.

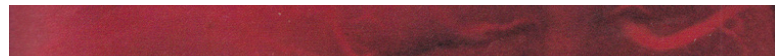
No DATUM miner on OCEAN ever built work on top of either Foundry block 941881 or 941882 (around a thousand globally diverse nodes).

Hughes noted that DATUM miners all run their own nodes and that there are somewhere around 1000 DATUM miners mining with OCEAN. When splits happen, Hughes says there is usually some percent of DATUM miners who see each side of the split. However, Hughes says yesterday's split was different:

not a single DATUM miner was building on either of the two eventually-winning Foundry blocks at 941881 or 941882. From my POV, there was zero indication of a race happening until Antpool and ViaBTC's blocks were proofed out of the chain.

So, I guess this sounds a lot like Foundry was selfish mining, which may be an attack or an optimization, depending on how you see it.

continued



Whatever you think about selfish mining, Jason Hughes also points out that Monday's two-block reorg is pretty much what an attempt to censor out a certain transaction would look like:

this is actually what a 51% attack targeting removal of a couple of blocks could actually look like. Generally you wouldn't need to give a public indication of success or attempt until you were successful. That's what seemed to happen here if viewed in a bit of a vacuum. (I'm not saying this was an attack, just that this is what one would look like.)

Important to know you really don't need 51% to pull off a few blocks of reorg consistently. For example, Foundry has more than enough centralized hash rate to have a very high chance of success if they were to do something like this intentionally.

It's worth noting though that had this been such an attempt, the hypothetically censored transaction still probably could have gotten through in an hour or two, when some other miner found a block -- especially if the hypothetically censored transaction bumped its fees.



top comment

340 sats \ 11 replies \ @Murch 25 Mar

Nodes will retrieve and store competing chaintips with the same amount of POW, when they are offered, but they will only propagate their best chaintip to peers. So a second competing block would not be forwarded. It would therefore be expected for competing blocks to propagate less widely than uncontested blocks.

< illustrated in this image

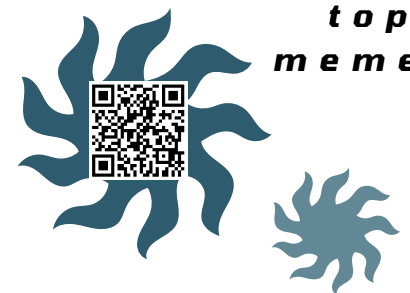


>

Foundry's first block was timestamped 12s after the Antpool block and Foundry's second block was timestamped six seconds after ViaBTC's block. Timestamps do not have to be super accurate, but looking at Foundry's recent blocks, those seem to be pretty accurate to the actual time (some miners time-roll, but it might be the case Foundry does not—I'd have to look more into it to confidently say so).

However, if the timestamps are accurate, it is possible that Foundry found both of those blocks just after the competing blocks were found, before they had learned about the competing blocks, but after their block would have propagated widely on the network.

MEME MONDAY - TOP MEME GOES IN THE NEWSLETTER



top
meme

204 sats \ 5 comments \ @sn 23 Mar memes

28 sats \ 1 reply \ @SHA256

man 23 Mar



@jinformatique 23 Mar

10 sats \ 0 replies \



I BUILT A WEBSITE SHOWING HOW

8351 sats \ 5 comments \ @sovenor

I started bitcoin.rocks back in 2022

because I was tired of the media narrative around Bitcoin.

Every headline was about price crashes, energy FUD, or scam associations. Meanwhile, Bitcoin is quietly helping protesters in Nigeria crowdfund when banks freeze their accounts, stabilizing the Texas power grid, and giving people in authoritarian countries a way to protect their savings.

So I built a site that collects the best of this – curated articles, videos, and data organized by how Bitcoin actually impacts the world. Human rights. Energy. Freedom. Housing. Food. Even art. About 20 categories, each with hand-picked resources from sources like Forbes, MIT Technology Review, TIME, Lyn Alden, and others.

A few things I'm proud of:

- It's fully open-source (<https://github.com/sovenor/bitcoin-rocks>)
- Volunteers have translated it into 9 languages
- There's a compound inflation calculator that shows people how much their salary needs to increase just to stay even
- We run a sticker campaign where anyone can request free stickers and post Bitcoin education in their city (bitcoin.rocks/stickers) – We've mailed out more than 55,000 stickers over the last few years (you can also print your own)
- A business adoption kit for getting local businesses to accept Bitcoin

I've never done any marketing for it. Just built it and let people find it. Gets about 1,500 visitors a month organically, which is cool but I know it could help way more people.

Figured I'd share it here since Stacker News is the kind of community that actually cares about this stuff. Would love feedback – what's missing? What would make it more useful?



BITCOIN MAKES THE WORLD BETTER

\ 26 Mar bitcoin bitcoin_beginners



YOU HEARD IT WAS BAD

BUT WHAT IF IT'S GOOD?

**WHAT IF BITCOIN IS
BUILDING A BETTER WORLD?**

**SEE THE PROOF AT
BITCOIN.ROCKS**



SCAN OR GO TO
BITCOIN.ROCKS